

Unit 3: Problems in the home**Lesson 1: Problems in the home****Introduction**

This lesson deals with the language needed to report a repair. Learners learn how to describe common problems and role-play reporting problems to the council or a landlord. Listening skills are also practised through activities based on an audio of a council tenant reporting a problem.

Time: Approximately 90 minutes. Timings are flexible and teachers can cut activities and add extension activities as required.

Aims

- To introduce vocabulary needed to describe problems in the home.
- To develop learners' ability to listen for gist and key details.
- To build learner confidence in phoning the council or a landlord to report a repair.

Objectives

All learners will be able to:

- Describe common problems in the home.
- Listen to a phone call and understand the gist and key details.
- Phone the council or a landlord to report a repair.

Some learners may be able to:

- Describe common problems in different ways, e.g. 'My toilet is blocked' and 'I've got a blocked toilet'.



Preparation**You will need:**

- **Worksheet 1 – Image and word cards:** 1 set per group, for the **Warmer**.
- **Worksheet 2 – Problems images and word cards:** 1 per learner, cut up, for **Activity 1** and one copy to display if possible.
- Glue sticks for **Activity 1**.
- **Worksheet 3 – Vocabulary consolidation:** 1 per learner for **Activity 1**.
- Audio for **Activities 2 & 3**.
- **Worksheet 4 – Listening tasks:** 1 per learner for **Activities 2 & 3**.
- **Worksheet 5 – Role cards:** 1 card per learner for **Activity 4**.

For the extension / homework tasks:

- **Worksheet 6 – Council repair reporting form:** 1 per learner for **Extension 1**.
- **Worksheet 7 – Writing frames:** 1 frame per learner for **Extension 2**.
- **Worksheet 8 – Local council Webquest:** 1 per learner for the **Homework**.
You could add the web address of the local council to the sheet before you copy it.



Problems in the home**Warmer – Vocab recap - household items (10 mins)**

- Hand out the image and word cards from **Worksheet 1**, one image or one word card for each learner.
- Explain that the learners need to go round the classroom saying but not showing what is on their card until they find the learner with the matching word or image.
- After all the cards have been matched, ask the pairs to show their cards to the class and at this point deal with any meaning or pronunciation issues.

Differentiation:

- Give beginner readers image cards.

Activity 1 – Problems in the home (20 mins)

- Hand out the image cards from **Worksheet 2** or display it on the whiteboard and ask pairs to discuss together how to describe the problems represented in the pictures.
- Hand out the word cards and ask the learners to match them to the images.
- Check as a class before learners stick the words and pictures in their notebooks.
- Ask learners to share any other ideas they had, writing valid and useful alternatives on the board.
- Hand out **Worksheet 3** and ask the learners to choose the correct word before checking with a partner and as a class.

Differentiation:

- Give stronger learners the alternative sentence structure: 'I've got a blocked toilet' and ask them to rephrase the problems from **Worksheets 2 & 3**.

Activity 2 – Listening (15 mins)

- Ask the class what they do if they have a problem in their home (e.g., call the council or landlord, or someone to come and fix it if it's their own house?)
- Tell the class they will hear someone reporting a problem and need to find out what the problem is.
- Play the audio and check as a class (the bathroom sink is leaking and there is water coming through the ceiling).
- Hand out **Worksheet 4** and ask the learners to listen again and find the answers to the questions.
- Check answers with a partner and as a class.

Activity 3 – Language to report a repair (20 mins)

- Play the audio again for learners to fill in the gaps for **Task 3** on **Worksheet 4** and ask them to match the questions and answers for **Task 4**.



- Help the learners memorise the sentences from **Task 3** by writing them on the board and asking them to read them repeatedly, but each time replacing one word with a drawn shape such as a triangle, star or heart.
- Continue until all the words are represented by symbols and the learners are saying the sentences from memory.

Activity 4 – Reporting a problem role-play (15 mins)

- Pair the learners and ask them to sit back-to-back.
- Hand out the role cards from **Worksheet 5**.
- Give learners a few minutes to read their cards and think about what to say and then ask them to role-play the phone call.
- Ask the learners to swap roles and practise again with a different problem card.

Differentiation:

- Give weaker learners the Student A card with the questions to read and stronger learners the Student A card with prompts only for them to make the questions.
- Stronger learners with the role of Student A could write down the answers to the questions
- Give beginner readers the role of the tenant.
- Stronger pairs might enjoy performing their role-play to the group.

Cooler – Tic Tac Toe game (10 mins)

- This is a variation on 'noughts and crosses'.
- Draw a 3 X 3 grid on the board and write a word from today's session in each box.
- Teams take it in turns to agree a sentence using one of the words.
- If they produce a correct sentence they can put a nought or a cross in the box.
- The first team to get three noughts or three crosses in a row wins.

Extension 1 – Online form requesting a council repair

- Ask any council tenants how they report a repair and whether they use an online form.
- Hand out **Worksheet 6** and explain that this is a form like one they would fill in online.
- Ask learners to complete the form. This is an editable PDF, so if you have IT access you could share it online and ask the learners to fill it in electronically.

Extension 2 – Emailing a friend about a problem

- Initiate a class discussion about who else you could contact about a problem (e.g. friend, family member etc.) and which kinds of problems a friend could help with.
- As a class, choose one of the problems from **Worksheet 2** or **3** and discuss ideas for what to put in an email to a friend about this problem.



- With beginner writers you could use a Language Experience approach, composing the email together and following up with activities as described in **Unit 2 Lesson 2**. Or ask learners to write the email using a writing frame from **Worksheet 7**.
- If you have IT access, the learners could email each other or you about their problem.

Homework

- Hand out **Worksheet 8** and give the learners the website of the local council.
- Ask the learners to find the information on the website for homework and check with a partner and as a class next lesson.

Tip:

- **Worksheet 8** is an editable PDF so that you can customise it to the information provided on your local council website.



Audio transcript

Council: Council, Housing Services.

Tenant: Hello. I'm phoning to report a repair. My bathroom sink is leaking.

C: What's your name, please?

T: Yes, it's Kaya Martens.

C: Can you spell that?

T: Yes. Kaya K – A – Y – A and Martens M – A – R – T – E – N – S.

C: Thank you. And what's your address?

T: Yes, it's 13 Main Road.

C: What's the postcode?

T: E21 1QP.

C: And what's the problem?

T: My bathroom sink is leaking. Water is everywhere and there is water coming through the ceiling.

C: OK. Someone will call you in 9 days to make an appointment to fix it.

T: 9 days? But it's an emergency!

C: OK...Mmmm... Someone can come tomorrow. Are you at home all day?

T: I'm at home in the morning, but I'm out in the afternoon. I'm in college from 1-3.30.

C: OK. Someone will come in the morning. What's your telephone number?

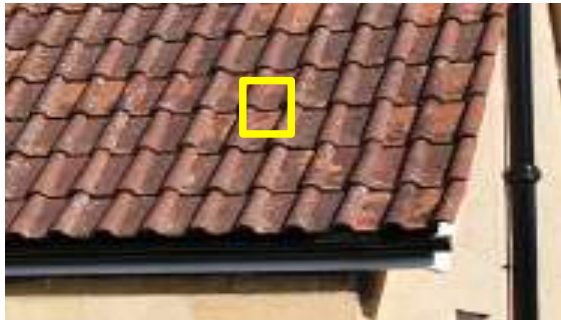
T: It's 07700 900638.

C: Thanks for your call. Bye.

T: Thanks. Bye.



Worksheet 1 – Images and word cards for the Warmer

	
	
	
boiler	sink
tap	toilet
wall	tile

Worksheet 2 – Problems images and descriptions for Activity 1



The wall is damp.

The boiler is broken.

The toilet is blocked.

The sink is leaking.

The tap is dripping.

A tile is missing.

Worksheet 3 – Activity 1: Vocabulary

Task 1

Circle the correct word.

1. The sink is **blocked** / blocking.
2. The washing machine is **leaked** / leaking.
3. The radiator is **dripped** / dripping.
4. My bin is **missed** / missing.
5. The cooker is **broked** / broken.
6. The ceiling is **damped** / damp.



Task 1

Circle the correct word.

1. The sink is **blocked** / blocking.
2. The washing machine is **leaked** / leaking.
3. The radiator is **dripped** / dripping.
4. My bin is **missed** / missing.
5. The cooker is **broked** / broken.
6. The ceiling is **damped** / damp.



Worksheet 4 – Activity 2: Reporting a repair (listening)

Task 1

Listen to the phone call. What's the problem?



Task 2

Listen again. Choose the correct answer to the questions.

1. What is leaking?
 - a. the kitchen sink b. the bathroom sink c. the bath
2. How do you spell Kaya's surname?
 - a. MARTINS b. MARTEN c. MARTENS
3. What is her address?
 - a. 13 Main Road b. 30 Main Road c. 30 May Road
4. What is her postcode?
 - a. E21 1QB b. E31 1QP c. E21 1QP
5. When is Kaya out tomorrow?
 - a. in the morning b. in the afternoon c. in the evening
6. What time is she at college?
 - a. 1-3pm b. 1-3.30pm c. 1-2.30pm
7. What is Kaya's telephone number?
 - a. 07700 900638 b. 07700 920638 c. 0770 920638

Task 3

Listen again. Which words go in the gaps?

1. I'm phoning to _____ a repair.
2. But it's an _____!
3. I'm _____ in the morning.
4. I'm _____ in the afternoon.

Task 4

Match the questions and answers.

What's your name?

I'm at home in the morning but I'm out in the afternoon.

What's your address?

07700 900638.

What's the postcode?

13 Main Road.

What's your telephone number?

My bathroom sink is leaking.

What's the problem?

Kaya Martens.

Are you at home all day tomorrow?

E21 1QP



Worksheet 5 – Role cards for Activity 4

Student A: Council • What's your name? • What's your address? • What's the postcode? • What's your telephone number? • What's the problem? • Are you at home all day tomorrow?	Student B: Tenant  At college 9.30 – 12.
Student A: Council • What's your name? • What's your address? • What's the postcode? • What's your telephone number? • What's the problem? • Are you at home all day tomorrow?	Student B: Tenant  At work 1pm – 9pm
Student A: Council • name? • address? • postcode? • telephone number? • problem? • at home all day tomorrow?	Student B: Tenant  At home in the morning. Out in the afternoon.
Student A: Council • name? • address? • postcode? • telephone number? • problem? • at home all day tomorrow?	Student B: Tenant  Taking children to school 8am and picking children up 3pm.

Additional resources**Worksheet 6 – Online council repair reporting form for Extension 1****Task 1***Fill in the form to report a problem to the council.***Online form: Non-emergency housing repair****Your details:**

Name:

Address:

Town / city:

Postcode:

Home telephone:

Mobile:

Email address:

Repair details:

Repair location (e.g. roof, stairs, wall etc.):

Repair details (e.g. sink is leaking etc.):

More information:

Ask for an appointment:

Day (please tick):

Monday

☐

Friday

☐

Tuesday

☐

Saturday

☐

Wednesday

☐

Sunday

☐

Thursday

☐

AM

☐

PM

☐

Time (please tick):

Please give dates and times when you are not at home (e.g. picking children up from school):

Extra information (e.g. use back door):



Worksheet 7 – Writing frames for Extension 2

Dear _____

I'm writing to ask for help.

Thanks.

Love from _____



Dear _____.

I'm writing to ask for help.

I've got a problem with my _____.

It's _____.

_____.

Can you _____.

_____.

I'm busy on _____ at _____.

_____ because _____.

_____.

I'm free on _____ at _____.

_____.

Can you come then?

Please let me know.

Thanks.

Love from _____.



Worksheet 8 – Homework: Local council Webquest**Task 1**

Use the internet and go to the council website: _____

Find this information on the website:

1. Telephone number to report a non-emergency repair: _____
2. When you can phone to report a non-emergency repair: _____

3. Email address to report a repair: _____
4. Telephone number to report an emergency repair: _____
5. Where you can go to report a repair: _____

**Task 1**

Use the internet and go to the council website: _____

Find this information on the website:

1. Telephone number to report a non-emergency repair: _____
2. When you can phone to report a non-emergency repair: _____

3. Email address to report a repair: _____
4. Telephone number to report an emergency repair: _____
5. Where you can go to report a repair: _____



Unit 3: Problems in the home**Lesson 2: Problems renting****Introduction**

This lesson focuses on some of the problems learners might face when renting, both privately and from the council or a housing association. Rights of tenants and landlords are introduced through a reading activity and there is a grammar focus on modals. The relatively challenging language and concepts of this lesson make it best placed towards the end of an Entry 1 programme. It would also be an ideal opportunity to work with a higher level class and have mixed levels working together.

The information is based on that provided by www.gov.uk and www.citizensadvice.org.uk and is correct at the time of writing, but regulations change so be careful to check these websites for up-to-date information before using the materials.

Please be aware that regulations in Scotland are slightly different. Those covered in this session do currently apply in Scotland but teachers in Scotland might want to consult www.gov.scot for up-to-date information.

Time: Approximately 90 minutes. Timings are flexible and teachers can cut activities and add extension activities as required.

Aims

- To review key vocabulary on the topic of renting.
- To raise awareness of some of the rights of tenants and landlords.
- To build confidence in looking for information on a website.
- To practise *can*, *can't* and *must* to express permission and obligation.

Objectives

All learners will be able to:

- Understand key vocabulary on the topic of renting such as *tenant*, *landlord*, *rent*, *deposit* etc.
- Talk about some of the rights of tenants and landlords.
- Read a website and understand where to find information.
- Use *can*, *can't* and *must* to express permission and obligation.

Some learners may be able to:

- Read a website and find key details.



Preparation**You will need:**

- **Worksheet 1 – Image of tenant and landlord:** 1 copy to display for the **Warmer**.
- **Worksheet 2 – Vocabulary pre-teach:** 1 per learner for **Activity 1**.
- **Worksheet 3 – Problems cards:** 1 per small group for **Activity 2**.
- **Worksheet 4 – Webpage:** 1 per learner for **Activities 3 & 4**.
- **Worksheet 5 – Questions:** 1 per learner for **Activities 3 & 4**.
- **Worksheet 6 – Vocabulary:** 1 per learner for **Activity 5**.

For the extension tasks:

- **Worksheet 7 – Reading a letter from a landlord:** 1 per learner for **Extension 1**.
- **Worksheet 8 – Signs & places cards:** 1 set per pair for **Extension 2**.



Problems renting**Warmer (10 mins)**

- Display the image from **Worksheet 1** and ask the learners who they think the people are and what they are doing.
- Use the image to elicit words like 'tenant', 'estate agent' and 'renting'.
- Ask the class how many people rent and who they rent from.
- Invite individuals to share with the group any problems they have renting.

Activity 1 – Vocabulary pre-teach (10 mins)

- Hand out **Worksheet 2** and explain that these are words the learners will need for today's lesson.
- Ask the learners to choose the correct word for the gaps.
- Check answers with a partner and as a group.

Answers: 1. rent 2. tenant 3. landlord / landlady 4. deposit 5. guarantor 6. safety check
7. access 8. repair 9. evict

Differentiation:

- Encourage learners to use a dictionary.
- Give weaker learners a modified worksheet with the initial letter of the word already in the gap.
- Early finishers can test each other on the vocabulary: one learner gives the meaning and their partner needs to remember the word.

Tip:

- 'guarantor' is not needed for the reading task, but is important in this context as many people from overseas looking to rent in the private sector will need one as they are unable to prove their credit history. You could ask the learners if they have come across this word and if they can explain the meaning to a partner in their own language.

Activity 2 – Problems (10 mins)

- Put learners into small groups and hand out the problem cards from **Worksheet 3**.
- Ask the learners to discuss in small groups if they have this problem or not and who can help with the problem (e.g. Council, friend, family member, housing charities etc.).
- Discuss as a class.

Activity 3 – Reading a webpage: tenants' and landlords' rights (15 mins)

- Hand out **Worksheet 4** and ask the learners to add the headings to the correct sections.
- Ask the groups to work together to find whether the answers to the tenants' questions are 'yes', 'no' or 'maybe', highlighting or underlining where they find the information.
- Check answers as a class.



Answers:

Task 1: 1. Rent; 2. Repairs; 3. Safety checks; 4. Access; 5. Deposits; 6. Eviction.

Task 2: 1. Yes, if the landlord agrees; 2. No; 3. No and no; 4. Yes. Once a year; 5. No; 6. Yes.

Activity 4 – Reading a webpage: detailed reading (15 mins)

- Hand out **Worksheets 5** and ask the learners to find the answers to the questions on the webpage and check their answers with a partner.
- Check answers as a class.

Answers:

Task 1: 1. b; 2. a; 3. c; 4. b; 5. a; 6. b.

Task 2:

1. www.moneyadvice.serice.org.uk or www.citizensadvice.org.uk
2. walls; roof; basins; sinks; baths; pipes; drains; heating; hot water
3. gas heaters or gas cookers
4. if you don't pay your bills or if you damage the house
5. the Council, Shelter or the CAB.

Differentiation:

- **Task 2** is more challenging. You could cut the sheet in half and only give this task to stronger learners.

Activity 5 – Vocabulary (10 mins)

- Hand out **Worksheet 6** and ask the learners to find the words on the webpage.
- Ask learners to compare their answers in pairs and then feed back to class.

Answers: 1. responsibilities; 2. serious; 3. pipes; 4. access; 5. court order

Differentiation:

- Give weaker learners the number of the paragraph where they can find the answer.

Activity 5 – Grammar focus: modals: *can* / *can't* / *must* (10 mins)

- Write on the board: 'I can speak English.' 'I can't speak English.' and 'You must speak English.' and discuss the differences in meaning of the modals as a class.
- Ask the learners to highlight / circle all the examples of *can*, *can't* and *must* on the webpage.
- Ask the following concept questions:
 - Is it possible for the landlord to keep your deposit? (yes)
 - Is it ok for the landlord to come to the house without telling you? (no)
 - Does the landlord have to check the boiler? (yes)
- Model and drill the pronunciation of the three words on their own and in connected speech.
- Put the learners in small groups and ask them to write down rules for their place of study, such as 'You can't eat or drink in the classroom'; 'You can smoke outside the gate' etc. and then share their ideas with the group.

Cooler – Listening for *can* / *can't* in connected speech (10 mins)

- Say some sentences using *can* and *can't*, speaking at a natural pace.



- If learners think they hear *can* they should stand up, and if they think they hear *can't* they should sit down.

Extension 1 – Reading a letter from a landlord

- Ask the learners if they ever get letters from their landlord / agent / the council / housing association and if so what they are about.
- Hand out **Worksheet 7** and explain that this is a letter from a landlord.
- Ask the learners to read the letter quickly to find out why the landlord is writing.
- Ask the learners to read the letter again more carefully to answer the true / false questions and check with a partner and as a class.
- With a strong group you could practise phoning or writing to arrange a more convenient time. Although the landlord has the right to enter the property at any time after giving the required notice, they might consider rearranging depending on the circumstances.

Answers: 1. yes; 2. no; 3. yes; 4. yes; 5. no; 6. no; 7. yes

Extension 2 – Reading signs and notices

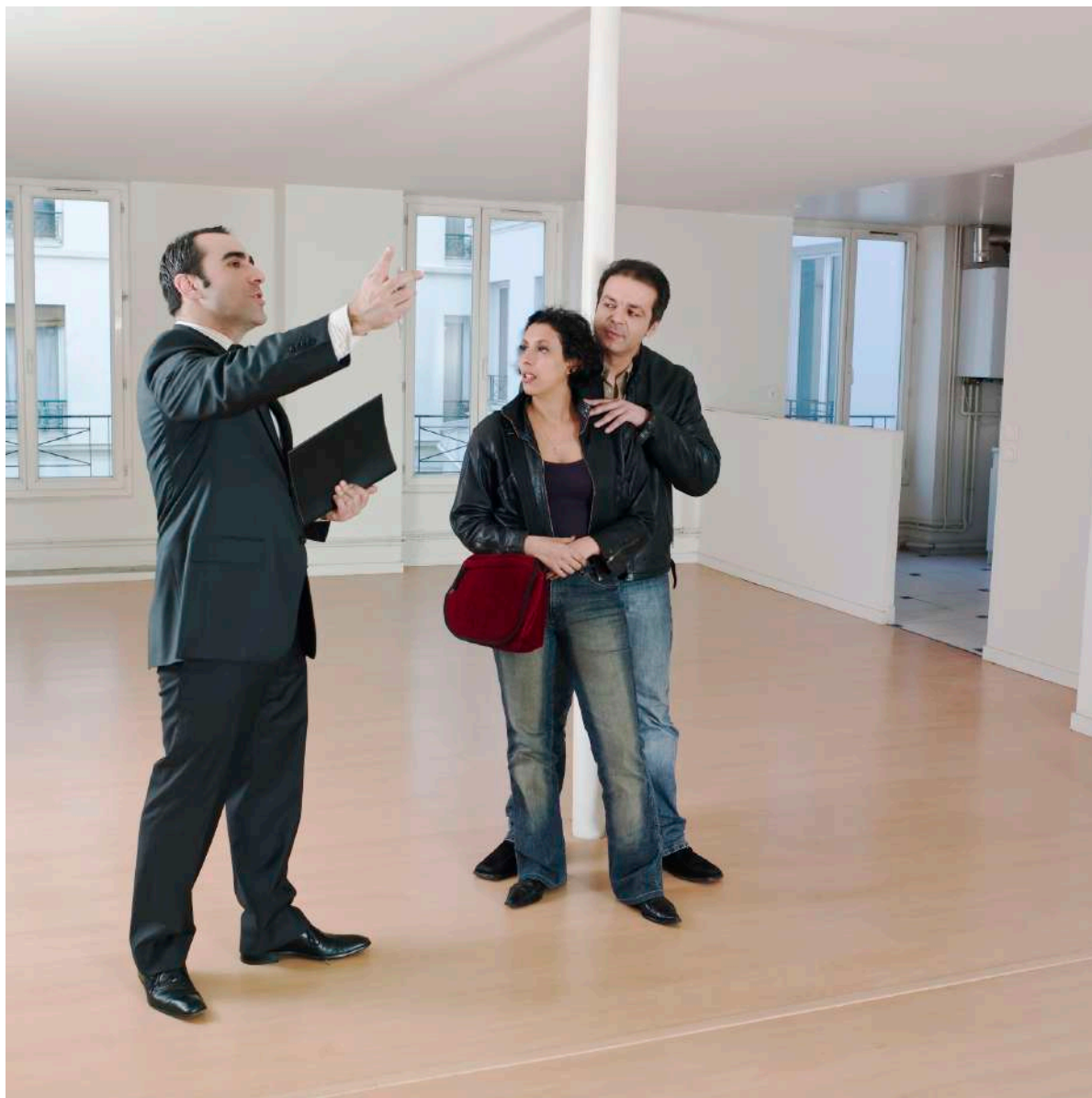
- Hand out the signs and places cards from **Worksheet 8** and ask pairs to match the signs to the places where you might find them.
- Check as a class and discuss what you should do if you see the signs.

Homework

- If learners live in accommodation such as a hostel, B & B or house of multiple occupancy, ask them to photograph on their mobile phones any signs they see where they live to show to the class in the next session and discuss what they mean.
- Ask stronger learners to complete the self-access online exercises available here: <https://esol.britishcouncil.org/content/learners/grammar-and-vocabulary/english-grammar/modal-verbs-obligation-and-permission>



Worksheet 1 – Image to display for Warmer



Worksheet 2 – Activity 1: Vocabulary

Task 1

Choose the correct word for the gap.

Use a dictionary to help you.

tenant	landlord / landlady	rent
deposit (noun)	repair	guarantor
safety check	evict	access

- I _____ my house. It isn't mine. I pay money to live in it.
- My house isn't mine. I pay money to live in it. I'm a _____.
- It isn't my house. It belongs to my _____.
- I want to move to a new house. I must pay rent for one month first. This is called a _____. I get this money back when I move out.
- My friend is my _____. If I can't pay my rent, my friend must pay it.
- My landlord must do a _____ to see if anything is dangerous in the house.
- My landlord wants _____ to the house. This means he wants to come into the house.
- If something is broken, you _____ it and it works again.
- My friend doesn't pay his rent. The landlady says he must leave the house. The landlady wants to _____ him.



Worksheet 3 – Problems cards for Activities 2 & 3

1  I can't pay my rent. Can I pay late?	2  My landlord says I must leave next week. Can he do this?
3  My boiler is broken and my landlady isn't repairing it. Can I repair it? Can I stop paying rent?	4  My landlord never checks the gas boiler is safe. Must he check it? How often?
5  My landlord comes to my house when I'm not there and without an appointment. Can he do this?	6  My landlady is keeping my deposit. Can she do this?

Worksheet 4 – Activities 3 & 4: Reading a webpage
Task 1

Write the correct heading in the gaps.

Deposits	Repairs	Rent	Eviction	Access	Safety checks
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Task 2

Use the information to answer the questions on the cards. Answer 'yes', 'no' or 'maybe'.

Renting – your rights and responsibilities
1. Rent

- ❖ If you can't pay, talk to your landlord. Maybe you can agree to pay late.
- ❖ If you have a serious problem and can't pay your rent, get help and advice from:
 - Money Advice Service: www.moneyadviceservice.org.uk
 - Shelter: www.shelter.org.uk
 - Citizens Advice: www.citizensadvice.org.uk

2.

- ❖ **Your landlord must repair:**
 - the walls and roof
 - basins, sinks, baths, pipes and drains
 - heating, hot water and boilers.
- ❖ **You must pay your rent, even if you are waiting for a repair.**

3.

- ❖ **Your landlord must check all gas boilers, heaters and cookers every year.**

4.

- ❖ **Your landlord can come into the house if he tells you 24 hours before.**

5.

- ❖ **Your landlord can keep some or all of your deposit if you don't pay your rent or bills, or if you damage the house.**
- ❖ **Your landlord can't keep your deposit if you don't agree.**

6.

- ❖ **If your contract is finished, your landlord can ask you to leave but he needs to tell you 2 months before**
- ❖ **If you don't pay your rent your landlord can get a court order to evict you.**
- ❖ **The rules for eviction are different for different contracts. Talk to the Council, Shelter or the CAB for more advice.**



Worksheet 5 – Activity 4: Reading a webpage

Task 1

Read the information on the webpage and circle the correct answer.

1. Which website can help if you can't pay your rent?
 - a. www.gov.org.uk
 - b. www.shelter.org.uk
 - c. www.moneysupermarket.com
2. What must your landlord repair?
 - a. the boiler
 - b. the TV if it's yours
 - c. the vacuum cleaner if it's full
3. How often must your landlord check your boiler?
 - a. 2 times in 1 year
 - b. 1 time in 2 years
 - c. 1 time in 1 year
4. How long after she tells you she's coming can a landlady come to your house?
 - a. 2 hours
 - b. 24 days
 - c. 24 hours
5. When can your landlady keep your deposit?
 - a. if you don't pay your rent
 - b. if she needs the money
 - c. if she wants to buy a new roof
6. Your contract is finished. Your landlord asks you to leave. How long before you must go?
 - a. 1 week
 - b. 2 months
 - c. 2 weeks



Task 2

Can you find other information on the website?

1. Another website to help you if you can't pay your rent: _____
2. Two other things your landlord must repair: _____
3. One thing your landlord must check every year: _____
4. One other situation when your landlady can keep our deposit: _____

5. One place you can go for advice about eviction: _____



Worksheet 6 - Activity 5: Vocabulary

Task 1

Find the words on the webpage with these meanings:

1. things you must do: **r** _____
2. big or difficult: **s** _____
3. water goes through them (see photo): **t** _____
4. Go in (a house): **a** _____



5. instructions from a judge: **c** _____ **o** _____



Task 1

Find the words on the webpage with these meanings:

1. things you must do: **r** _____
2. big or difficult: **s** _____
3. water goes through them (see photo): **t** _____
4. go in (a house): **a** _____



5. instructions from a judge:
c _____ **o** _____



Additional resources
Worksheet 7 – Extension 1: Reading a letter from a landlord
Task 1

Read the letter.

Why is the landlord writing?

Oldton Estates

1 High St.
Oldton

5th June 2015

Dear Ms Saha,

We'd like to inspect the house.

We're coming next Tuesday at 11.00 am.

You don't need to be there. We can let ourselves in with a key.

Yours sincerely,

P.Smith

Paul Smith

Managing Director, Oldton Estates

Task 2

Read the letter again.

Are these sentences correct?

1. The date on the letter is 5/6/15.
2. The letter is for Paul Smith.
3. The letter is from Paul Smith.
4. They are coming to the house on Tuesday.
5. They are coming to the house in the evening.
6. Ms Saha must be in the house.
7. Paul Smith has got a key.

Yes	No



Worksheet 8 – Signs and places cards for Extension 2